

How to use create-react-app with an older React version?

Asked 4 years, 8 months ago Modified 10 days ago Viewed 51k times



42



javascript reactjs create-react-app



18



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asked Oct 4, 2017 at 13:59



rodrigocfd

4,116 4 21 51

2 You can specify version of package in package.json. This might help:

stackoverflow.com/questions/22343224/... – Rajesh Oct 4, 2017 at 14:00

I directly changed package.json to version 15.6.2, and to my surprise it just worked! Make it an answer, let me upvote you. – rodrigocfd Oct 4, 2017 at 14:11

I'm glad that I was able to help you. If you are satisfied with solution, you can just remove the post as I would mark it as duplicate anyways. Have a good day :-)

Possible duplicate of [npm install the exact package version specified in package.json](#) – Rajesh Oct 4, 2017 at 14:52

7 Answers

Sorted by:

Highest score (default)



72



If you're here because of react v18, and you want to go down to the previous non-change breaking version, here's what i did:

in your `package.json` replace:

```
"react": "^18.0.0"
"react-dom": "^18.0.0"
```

with

```
"react": "^17.0.2"
"react-dom": "^17.0.2"
```

Then go to your entry file `index.js` At the top, replace:

```
import ReactDOM from 'react-dom/client'
```

with

```
import ReactDOM from 'react-dom';
```

Still in your `index.js` file, replace:

```
const root = ReactDOM.createRoot(document.getElementById('root'));
root.render(
  <React.StrictMode>
    <App />
  </React.StrictMode>
);
```

with

```
ReactDOM.render(
  <React.StrictMode>
    <App />
  </React.StrictMode>,
  document.getElementById('root')
);
```

- Delete your `node_modules` and run `yarn install`
- After installation, run `yarn start`
- Enjoy

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answered Apr 18 at 6:46



[symplytheo](#)

731 ● 3 ● 4

- 1 I received errors while trying to install a new package. To fix, I also had to change `@testing-library/react` to version 12 in my package.json. I.e.: "`@testing-library/react`": "`^12.0.0`" and "`@testing-library/user-event`": "`^12.0.0`" – [Matt](#) May 21 at 8:26



22



It seems that you can just go ahead and use it to generate a React 16 app, then edit package.json and run `npm i` (or `npm install`; `npm i` is just a shortcut).

I just left the `react-scripts` version at the latest version and only changed the versions of `react` and `react-dom`, and it worked:



```
"devDependencies": {
  "react-scripts": "1.0.14"
```

```
},  
"dependencies": {  
  "react": "^15.6.1",  
  "react-dom": "^15.6.1"  
},
```

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answered Oct 13, 2017 at 21:19



Matt Browne

11.7k ● 4 ● 53 ● 73

6 make sure to delete node_modules folder before doing 'npm install' – [Shamseer Ahammed](#) Aug 5, 2021 at 7:44

Complementing the answers described above, after all the manipulation, I had to update this libs(for TS template) :

9

```
"@testing-library/react": "^12.1.1",  
"@testing-library/user-event": "^12.5.0"
```

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answered Apr 18 at 11:19



FreeDevM

91 ● 1 ● 2

I ran into this problem, especially with the new create-react-app v18. All I did was to delete my package-lock.json file and also my node_modules folder. I edited package.json afterwards, replaced react-dom and react with the version that I want as below:

5

```
"react": "^17.0.2",  
"react-dom": "^17.0.2",
```

Finally, I installed my packages again using `npm install`

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edited Apr 14 at 20:42

answered Apr 11 at 23:49



Dennis

user 105 ● 1 ● 5

I think there were some breaking changes, and the CRA index (and maybe other files) were updated to the new way to do things in v18 -- haven't tried yet, but might need to undo the changes described here reactjs.org/blog/2022/03/08/react-18-upgrade-guide.html – [Justin L.](#) Apr 13 at 17:05

If you already created with `React 18`, you can downgrade version 18 to previous versions of react with a few steps. You will need to do modifications in two files which are `package.json` and

3

`index.js` . You should delete also `node_modules`

Step 1

Your `index.js` probably looks like this now

```
import React from "react";
import ReactDOM from "react-dom/client";
import "./index.css";
import App from "./App";

const root = ReactDOM.createRoot(document.getElementById("root"));
root.render(
  <React.StrictMode>
    <App />
  </React.StrictMode>
);
```

You should change import of `ReactDOM` and cancel `const root` line

New code of `index.js` should be like this

```
import React from "react";
import ReactDOM from "react-dom";
import "./index.css";
import App from "./App";

ReactDOM.render(
  <React.StrictMode>
    <App />
  </React.StrictMode>
  document.getElementById('root')
);
```

Step 2

Go to your `package.json` file and update desired react version in dependencies

```
"dependencies": {
  ...
  "react": "^17.0.0",
  "react-dom": "^17.0.0",
  ...
},
```

Step 3

Delete your `node_modules` and If you are using **npm** do `npm i` . If you are using **yarn** do `yarn install` . After this step you are good to run app with `npm start` or `yarn start` .

Step 4 (OPTIONAL: If you are still having problems but I do not recommend doing it)

Delete your `package-lock.json` (for **npm**) or `yarn.lock` file (for **yarn**) and start back from **Step 3**

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answered May 14 at 15:09



Evren

user

3,566 ● 1 ● 6 ● 13

First you have to install npm in your system Then For Create react app you have to run below command

1

```
sudo npm init react-app my-app --scripts-version 1.1.5
```

```
cd my-app
```

```
sudo npm install --save react@16.0.0
```

```
sudo npm install --save react-dom@16.0.0
```

It worked like a charm for me.

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edited Apr 21 at 12:33



Gmosy Gnaq

517 ● 1 ● 4 ● 18

answered Apr 20, 2020 at 4:17



manoj patel

user

856 ● 6 ● 9

3 Usually using `sudo` isn't a good idea for a folder containing an app – [Matt Browne](#) Jun 13, 2021 at 22:08

this worked for me in ubuntu 20.04. CRA kept crashing but this one launched in a minute – [Hank W](#) Nov 21, 2021 at 18:00

Specify your script version while create project

-3

```
sudo npm init react-app appname --scripts-version 1.0.13
```

its working for me



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answered Apr 4, 2020 at 16:39



manoj patel

user

856 ● 6 ● 9